

15 November 2024

To : All licensed corporations, licensed representatives and registered institutions within the meaning of the Securities and Futures Ordinance (Cap. 571) or relevant individuals within the meaning of section 20(10) of the Banking Ordinance (Cap. 155)

Dear Sirs,

Zuo Ping (“Ms Zuo”) [REDACTED]

On 15 November 2024 the Takeovers and Mergers Executive of the SFC (“**Executive**”) issued a “cold shoulder order” (“**Order**”) for a 6-year period in respect of Ms Zuo starting on 15 November 2024 and ending on 14 November 2030 (both dates inclusive). Please see the enclosed copy of the Order.

We are writing to you to draw your attention to the fact that the Order requires that all licensed corporations, licensed representatives, registered institutions or relevant individuals must not, without the prior written consent of the Executive, act or continue to act directly or indirectly in their capacity as licensed corporations, licensed representatives, registered institutions or relevant individuals for Ms Zuo or any corporations controlled by her (as defined in the Hong Kong Codes on Takeovers and Mergers and Share Buy-backs (“**Codes**”)) other than CBK Holdings Limited and its subsidiaries (within the meaning of the Codes); or knowingly assist directly or indirectly in a breach of the Order during the period commencing on 15 November 2024 and ending on 14 November 2030 (both dates inclusive).

Please note that the Order is not intended to cover the provision of normal banking services insofar as those services do not constitute regulated activities as defined under the Securities and Futures Ordinance (Cap. 571).

We also draw your attention to section 12.4 of the Introduction to the Codes, which provides that “*[f]ailure of any licensed corporation, licensed representative, registered institution, or relevant individuals, to comply with either of the Codes, or a ruling, or a requirement not to act for a named person in accordance with section 12.2(c) above, is a breach of the Codes and may result in disciplinary proceedings against such corporation, representative, institution, or individual under this section 12. It may (in accordance with the provisions of the relevant Ordinances) also lead to suspension or revocation of the licence or registration of such entity or person.*”

In order to comply with the Order, licensed corporations and registered institutions should take all appropriate measures to ensure that licensed representatives and relevant individuals within their organisations are aware of and comply with the Order.



Finally, please note that personal information relating to Ms Zuo in this letter must only be used for the purpose of complying with the Order. If you have any questions as to the scope and effect of the Order, please do not hesitate to contact our general enquiry hotline at 2231 1210.

Yours faithfully,

Michael Duignan
Executive Director
Corporate Finance Division